



why elon musk's twitter purchase sucks

How Twitter might change for the worse and won't level the playing field for all

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Ordinary people like you and me buy chocolate for kicks, maybe something more fanciful and if there's a special occasion to splurge. Those rules obviously don't apply to the richest person in the world; Elon Musk doesn't need any rhyme or reason to drop \$44 billion to purchase Twitter, one of the world's most popular social media platforms.

The news has obviously caused a huge stir online, dividing opinions and splitting everyone into two camps – those who think Elon Musk is going to help Twitter and its users in a radical new way, which remains to be seen. Others think Twitter getting sold to Elon Musk is bad news not just for both the parties involved, but also for all Twitter users. It's the crossing of the rubicon, the point of no return – for Twitter, Elon Musk

and of course netizens who use the microblogging platform.

WHY IT'S BAD NEWS FOR TWITTER AND US

Twitter was a publicly traded company until Elon Musk's purchase kicked in, if you remember. One of the consequences of a public company going private is it reduces the amount of scrutiny it's subjected to by shareholders, regulators and the media in general. This could've a significant impact on Twitter users with respect to their online privacy – the data that's shared and collected by the platform.

For example, Twitter (solely controlled by Elon Musk) wouldn't have to legally announce changes to its strategy or operations that are big enough to fundamentally change its core product offering because it

would no longer be a public company. People can't sue Twitter if it doesn't make such disclosures in the future, and as the sole owner Elon Musk would be perfectly within his rights to do whatever changes he deemed fit to the social media platform without having to worry about taking anyone's permission.

Imagine if Elon Musk's Twitter suffered a data breach, the kind of which jeopardizes private user data of millions of Twitter users. How can the world hold Twitter or Elon Musk responsible if it doesn't affect their stock price, the most effective way of keeping big corporate tech entities accountable? You think Elon Musk will care if there's no economic blowback to any of Twitter's missteps under his watch?

According to Elon Musk, Twitter will need to open-source its algorithm, which is an essential step in ensuring the platform adheres to free-speech principles in its extreme, unapologetic, legally binding form. In a world where every social media platform from Reddit to Facebook is deploying more money and manpower towards moderating content on their websites, Twitter wants to usher in the wild wild west of the interwebs – a more sanitized version of 4chan, if you will. Are millions of Twitter users worldwide going to seamlessly adjust to this new reality? Seemingly not, because ever since news broke of Elon Musk buying Twitter a lot of users (arguably not in millions) vowed to stop using Twitter and have already started deleting their profiles.



How will Twitter's purchase impact its user privacy